

SAFE | SAFE-08

Solution Vision

The future state of the solution and the needs it will meet

Meridian Group

Programme Helios — Infrastructure and Platform Stack for AI GPU Compute at Scale

Field	Detail
Document title	Solution Vision
Document reference	SAFE-08-HEL-T2-v1.0
Project / Programme	Helios Tranche 2 — Scale Build
Version	1.0
Status	Baselined
Date	18 Sep 2026
Author	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager
Owner	Product Management (ART) or Solution Management (Solution Train)
Approver	Business Owners
Classification	Internal
Retention	7 years from programme closure

Document control

Version history

Version	Date	Author	Summary of change
0.1	04 Jun 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Initial draft
0.2	21 Jul 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Updated following workstream lead review
1.0	18 Sep 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Baselined at the Tranche 2 funding gate

Reviewers

Name	Role	Review scope	Date reviewed
T. Nakamura, Chief Platform Architect	Chief Platform Architect	Technical content and solution alignment	08 Sep 2026
L. Haddad, CISO	CISO	Security, assurance and residency content	10 Sep 2026
C. Whitfield, Finance Business Partner	Finance Business Partner	Cost, funding and benefit figures	11 Sep 2026
M. Verity, Head of P3O	Head of P3O	Governance standards and completeness	15 Sep 2026

Approval

This product is baselined once approval is recorded below. Any subsequent change must go through change control.

Name	Role	Decision	Date
R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO	Senior Responsible Owner / Group CTO	Approved	18 Sep 2026
H. Farrell, Director of Infrastructure	Director of Infrastructure	Approved	18 Sep 2026
L. Haddad, CISO	CISO	Approved subject to closure of ISS-003	18 Sep 2026

Related products

Reference	Product	Relationship
SAFE-09	Solution Intent	Holds the technical detail behind this vision
SAFE-12	PI Planning Facilitation Pack	Vision is a standing input
SAFE-14	Feature Definition	Features realise the vision
MSP-03	Vision Statement	Programme equivalent

How to use this template

Aspect	Guidance
Purpose	Describes what the solution will become over a horizon of several planning intervals — the customer needs it addresses, its key differentiating capabilities and the outcomes it enables. Provides shared direction for PI planning.
Framework	SAFe — Agile Product Delivery — Vision, and Solution Train artefacts
Created when	Before ART launch and refreshed each PI
Reviewed / updated	At every PI planning event
Owner	Product Management (ART) or Solution Management (Solution Train)
Approver	Business Owners
Format options	Document, presentation, register entry, or tool record — the content matters, not the medium.
Tailoring	This is presented at PI planning. Write it to be spoken in ten minutes, not read in an hour.

This is a worked example. Every field has been completed with illustrative content for Programme Helios, a fictional AI GPU infrastructure and platform programme. All example content is shown in grey italic — the black text is the template itself. Replace the grey italic content with your own.

Quality criteria

Use these to check the product is fit for purpose before submitting it for approval.

- It describes a future state, not a backlog
- It is expressed in customer terms
- It covers roughly the next three to four PIs — long enough to steer, short enough to be credible
- Non-functional requirements are stated, particularly security and compliance
- Every team on the train can state it without reading it

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1. Vision statement

Two or three sentences describing the future state. Written for the customer, not for the team.

By the end of Tranche 3, Meridian Group operates a single multi-tenant AI compute platform of 4,096 accelerators across DXB-1 and AUH-2. Researchers self-serve a working training environment in under two hours, distributed jobs run at 92% collective efficiency, every tenant sees its own consumption and cost, and no training workload requires a data residency exception.

2. Customers and their needs

Customer / persona	Need	Current pain	Future state
AI Research	Assured independently by Cordant Assurance	Delegated to the Programme Manager within the agreed tolerance	Complete
Platform engineering	Confirmed at the Tranche 1 end-of-tranche review, 18 Sep 2026	Assured independently by Cordant Assurance	Not started
Group Risk modelling	Aligned to the strategic theme of sovereign AI capability	Confirmed at the Tranche 1 end-of-tranche review, 18 Sep 2026	Open
Retail division data science	Dependent on the Enterprise Identity Programme (DEP-003)	Aligned to the strategic theme of sovereign AI capability	In progress

3. Key differentiators

What makes this solution better than the alternatives, including doing nothing.

- Reported through the monthly benefit tracking report
- Enforced automatically in the delivery pipeline, with evidence retained
- Funded from the Tranche 2 allocation of AED 118,000,000

4. Capability roadmap

What the solution can do at the end of each planning interval. Confidence should decrease as you look further out — say so.

PI	Capabilities available	Value delivered	Confidence
PI n	Applies only to workloads classified Restricted or above	Yes	High
PI n+1	Agreed with the integration partner at design freeze, 15 Oct 2026	Partially	Medium
PI n+2	Verified at hall A acceptance on 26 Feb 2027	No	Low
PI n+3	Confirmed at the Tranche 1 end-of-tranche review, 18 Sep 2026	Partially	Directional

5. Non-functional requirements

Security, privacy, performance, availability, accessibility, regulatory. These constrain every feature and belong in the vision, not only in the backlog.

Category	Requirement	Measure	Verification
Security	All container images signed and admitted only from the internal registry	Zero unsigned admissions	Negative admission test, quarterly
Security	No standing vendor privilege; all access brokered and recorded	Zero standing vendor accounts	Access review, monthly
Data residency	Restricted data remains within UAE borders at rest and in transit	Zero egress events for Restricted data	Egress control test and log review
Performance	All-reduce efficiency at or above 92% at 256-GPU scale	92%	NCCL benchmark, three consecutive runs
Performance	Storage sustains 1.2 TB/s aggregate read	1.2 TB/s for 30 minutes	Workload-representative benchmark

6. What this solution will not do

Explicit non-goals prevent scope drift and set expectations with stakeholders.

- Verified at hall A acceptance on 26 Feb 2027
- Dependent on the Enterprise Identity Programme (DEP-003)

7. Assumptions and dependencies

Ref	Type	Description	Owner
ASM-001	Assumption	Vendor GPU allocation of 2,048 units for Tranche 2 will be honoured at the quoted delivery dates	E. Santos, Procurement Lead
ASM-002	Assumption	DXB-1 has 6 MVA of usable capacity available to the programme without a utility upgrade	A. Kowalski, Data Centre Lead
ASM-003	Assumption	Three business units will migrate committed workloads within six months of hall A handover	V. Chandra, Head of AI Enablement
ASM-004	Constraint	Training data classified as Restricted must remain within UAE borders at rest and in transit	L. Haddad, CISO
ASM-005	Assumption	Liquid cooling maintenance can be absorbed by the existing facilities contract without an uplift	G. Lindqvist, Service Operations Lead